

D030

Leadership and Management in Complex Healthcare Systems

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A new nurse director of a 200-bed hospital with a strong football-sponsorship program shares a vision of zero preventable harm, mentors charge nurses to lead improvement projects, and invites staff ideas. Which style is this?

- A. Autocratic, because she sets the vision.
- B. Transactional.
- C. Laissez-faire.
- D. Transformational.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A manager gives bonuses to staff who meet monthly hand-hygiene targets and writes up those who miss them. Which style is this?

- A. Servant.
- B. Democratic, since targets were set.
- C. Transformational.
- D. Transactional.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A CNO at a hospital with a newly renovated lobby plans to launch a new bedside handoff process. Staff believe the current process works fine, though handoff errors doubled last year. What should she do first, using Kotter's model?

- A. Announce the new process and start training next week.
- B. Create urgency by sharing the handoff error data with staff.
- C. Anchor the new process in policy immediately.
- D. Celebrate short-term wins.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A unit needs a \$95,000 ultrasound machine expected to last eight years, plus \$4,000 a month in supplies. The unit was rated top in patient experience last year. Where does the machine belong?

- A. The personnel budget.
- B. The capital budget.
- C. The operating budget, with the supplies.
- D. Neither, because top-rated units get grants.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which expense belongs in the operating budget?

- A. A new nurse-call system for the whole tower.
- B. Twenty new hospital beds.
- C. Staff nurse salaries.
- D. A renovation of the unit's rooms.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A unit needs one charge nurse on duty 24 hours a day, 7 days a week. Full-time staff work 40 hours a week; the unit also uses 12-hour shifts and has a new scheduling app. Ignoring vacation and sick time, how many FTEs are needed for this one position?

- A. 4.2 FTE
- B. 3.0 FTE
- C. 2.0 FTE
- D. 14 FTE

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A budget allows 8.4 FTE at 40 hours per week for one role. How many hours of weekly coverage does that buy?

- A. 8.4 hours
- B. 17,472 hours
- C. 336 hours, enough for two people around the clock.
- D. 168 hours

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A 30-bed unit had an average daily census of 25 patients. On one day, nursing staff worked 200 care hours. The unit's manager holds a DNP. What were the hours per patient day?

- A. 8.0
- B. 0.125
- C. 200
- D. 6.7

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A unit targets 7.5 HPPD with a census of 24. How many nursing care hours should be scheduled for the day?

- A. 3.2 hours
- B. 24 hours
- C. 31.5 hours
- D. 180 hours

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

Two unit managers dispute which unit gets two open float-pool nurses. After a long discussion they design a shared float schedule that meets both units' peak-hour needs. Both managers attended the same graduate program. Which mode did they use?

- A. Avoiding.
- B. Compromising.
- C. Collaborating.
- D. Accommodating.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

During a procedure, an experienced circulating nurse notices a count discrepancy and asks to stop. The senior surgeon, who has published widely, says to continue. In a high-reliability organization, what should happen?

- A.** Stop and resolve the count; the frontline expert's concern takes priority over rank.
- B.** Stop only if a second nurse always agrees.
- C.** Continue and report the discrepancy later.
- D.** Continue, because the surgeon has the most authority.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

An RN on a busy medical unit with a new coffee machine is assigned five patients, including one newly admitted with chest pain. Which task may she delegate to unlicensed assistive personnel?

- A.** Teaching insulin injection to a patient going home.
- B.** Taking vital signs on a stable post-op patient.
- C.** Evaluating a patient's response to a new pain medication.
- D.** The initial assessment of the chest-pain admission.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A new nurse director of a 200-bed hospital ~~with a strong football sponsorship program~~ shares a vision of zero preventable harm, mentors charge nurses to lead improvement projects, and invites staff ideas. Which style is this?

Target word: leadership style **Decides:** Vision, inspiration, and developing people.

A	Inverted operation	She invites input rather than dictating.
B	Confusion set	Transactional relies on rewards and corrections for meeting targets.
C	Adjacent category	Hands-off leadership with little direction.
D	Correct	Shared vision and developing others.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

A manager gives bonuses to staff who meet monthly hand-hygiene targets and writes up those who miss them. Which style is this?

Target word: style from behaviors **Decides:** Rewards and corrections for meeting targets.

A	Adjacent category	Servant leadership centers staff needs and growth.
B	Inverted operation	Setting targets is not shared decision-making.
C	Confusion set	No vision or development is described.
D	Correct	Exchanges of rewards and consequences.

3. Answer B Concept 2

A CNO ~~at a hospital with a newly renovated lobby~~ plans to launch a new bedside handoff process. Staff believe the current process works fine, though handoff errors doubled last year. What should she do first, using Kotter's model?

Target word: first step **Decides:** Staff see no problem.

A	Inverted operation	Communicating the vision before urgency reverses the sequence.
B	Correct	Kotter begins with a sense of urgency.
C	Absolute language	Anchoring is the last step, not the first.
D	Dropped element	There are no wins yet; that step comes later.

4. Answer B Concept 3

A unit needs a \$95,000 ultrasound machine expected to last eight years, plus \$4,000 a month in supplies. ~~The unit was rated top in patient experience last year.~~ Where does the machine belong?

Target word: budget category **Decides:** Costly, long-lived purchase.

A	Adjacent category	Covers salaries and benefits.
B	Correct	Major purchases with multi-year lives are capital.
C	Confusion set	Supplies are operating; the machine is capital.
D	Camouflage	The rating does not decide budget category.

5. Answer C Concept 3 • transfer

Which expense belongs in the operating budget?

Target word: identify an operating expense **Decides:** Day-to-day, recurring cost.

A	Inverted operation	A major long-lived purchase: capital.
B	Adjacent category	Costly long-lived equipment: capital.
C	Correct	Recurring costs of running the unit.
D	Confusion set	Construction is capital.

6. Answer A Concept 4

A unit needs one charge nurse on duty 24 hours a day, 7 days a week. Full-time staff work 40 hours a week; ~~the unit also uses 12-hour shifts and has a new scheduling app.~~ Ignoring vacation and sick time, how many FTEs are needed for this one position?

Target word: FTEs for 24/7 coverage **Decides:** 168 hours / 40 hours.

A	Correct	$24 \times 7 = 168$ hours; $168 / 40 = 4.2$.
B	Dropped element	Counts shifts per day, not hours per week.
C	Camouflage	Two 12-hour shifts per day, ignoring hours per FTE.
D	Wrong stem number	Counts 12-hour shifts per week ($168 / 12$).

7. Answer C Concept 4 • transfer

A budget allows 8.4 FTE at 40 hours per week for one role. How many hours of weekly coverage does that buy?

Target word: solve for hours **Decides:** $FTE \times 40$.

A	Confusion set	Reads the FTE count as hours instead of multiplying by 40.
B	Wrong stem number	That is the annual figure ($8.4 \times 2,080$), not weekly.
C	Correct	$8.4 \times 40 = 336$; $336 / 168 = 2$ positions.
D	Dropped element	One position's coverage only.

8. Answer A Concept 5

A 30-bed unit had an average daily census of 25 patients. On one day, nursing staff worked 200 care hours. ~~The unit's manager holds a DNP.~~ What were the hours per patient day?

Target word: HPPD **Decides:** $200 / 25$.

A	Correct	$200 / 25 = 8.0$.
B	Inverted operation	Divides patients by hours.
C	Dropped element	Hours without a denominator.
D	Wrong stem number	Divides by the 30 beds.

9. Answer D Concept 5 · transfer

A unit targets 7.5 HPPD with a census of 24. How many nursing care hours should be scheduled for the day?

Target word: solve for hours **Decides:** HPPD × patient days.

A	Inverted operation	Divides 24 by 7.5.
B	Wrong stem number	The census, not hours.
C	Confusion set	Adds the HPPD and the census instead of multiplying.
D	Correct	$7.5 \times 24 = 180$.

10. Answer C Concept 6

Two unit managers dispute which unit gets two open float-pool nurses. After a long discussion they design a shared float schedule that meets both units' peak-hour needs. ~~Both managers attended the same graduate program.~~ Which mode did they use?

Target word: conflict mode **Decides:** Both parties' core needs fully met.

A	Adjacent category	The conflict was addressed, not deferred.
B	Confusion set	Compromise means each gives up something.
C	Correct	A solution that fully meets both sides' key needs.
D	Inverted operation	One side yields to the other.

11. Answer A Concept 7

During a procedure, an experienced circulating nurse notices a count discrepancy and asks to stop. The senior surgeon, ~~who has published widely,~~ says to continue. In a high-reliability organization, what should happen?

Target word: HRO response **Decides:** Defer to expertise, preoccupation with failure.

A	Correct	HROs defer to expertise and treat small signals seriously.
B	Absolute language	A rigid rule not required by HRO principles.
C	Dropped element	Drops the immediate safety action.
D	Inverted operation	Rank over expertise is the opposite of HRO practice.

12. Answer B Concept 8

An RN on a busy medical unit ~~with a new coffee machine~~ is assigned five patients, including one newly admitted with chest pain. Which task may she delegate to unlicensed assistive personnel?

Target word: delegable task **Decides:** Routine task with predictable outcome.

A	Confusion set	Teaching requires RN judgment.
B	Correct	Routine, stable, predictable.
C	Inverted operation	Evaluation stays with the RN.
D	Adjacent category	Assessment of a new, unstable patient stays with the RN.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	4	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	2	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	2	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Transformational vs. transactional leadership	Transformational leaders inspire with a shared vision and develop people; transactional leaders manage through rewards, corrections, and clear exchanges.	Calling any effective or friendly leader transformational.	Vision, inspiration, and growth vs. rewards for meeting targets.
2	Kotter's change sequence	Change starts with a sense of urgency and a guiding coalition before vision, communication, removing barriers, short-term wins, and anchoring in culture.	Announcing the new process before people see why it matters.	A leader about to launch change to staff who see no problem.
3	Operating vs. capital budget	The operating budget covers day-to-day revenue and expenses (salaries, supplies); the capital budget covers major long-lived purchases above a set cost threshold.	Putting a large equipment purchase in the operating budget or salaries in capital.	A purchase with a multi-year life and high cost.
4	FTE calculation	One FTE = 40 hours a week (2,080 hours a year); covering one position around the clock takes $168 / 40 = 4.2$ FTE before benefit time.	Thinking one position around the clock equals 3 FTE because there are three shifts.	A position that must be filled 24/7.
5	Hours per patient day (HPPD)	HPPD = total nursing care hours / patient days for the same period.	Dividing by number of nurses or by beds instead of patient days.	Nursing hours and a census in the same stem.
6	Conflict management modes	Collaborating seeks a solution that fully meets both parties' key needs; compromising splits the difference; avoiding, accommodating, and competing favor one side or delay.	Calling a split-the-difference deal collaboration.	Whether both sides' core concerns are fully met or each gives something up.
7	High reliability principles	High reliability organizations stay preoccupied with failure, avoid simplifying, stay sensitive to operations, build resilience, and defer to expertise, not rank.	Letting the most senior person decide a safety question outside their expertise.	A frontline expert with a safety concern overruled by hierarchy.
8	Delegation to assistive personnel	The RN may delegate routine tasks with predictable outcomes but keeps assessment, teaching, evaluation, and judgment for unstable patients.	Delegating an assessment because the task seems simple.	A task involving initial assessment, teaching, or an unstable patient.

Course scope (public description): Leadership and Management in Complex Healthcare Systems prepares graduate nurses to be thoughtful strategists and informed decision-makers who serve as strong leaders in high-performing healthcare systems. Students develop competencies for managing diverse teams in complex systems, monitoring and measuring organizational performance, allocating financial and human resources, and leading change towards a transformed healthcare system. Additionally, students acquire the knowledge and skills

to become full partners with other healthcare professionals by demonstrating nurse contributions toward high-quality care to patients and populations, while working collaboratively with interprofessional teams. There are no prerequisites for this course.